

Practical AI Workflows

Hands-on workflow training for writing, planning, research support, meeting preparation, and everyday knowledge work.

Format	Two 90-minute Zoom sessions or one half-day remote workshop.
Level	Level 2: practical workflow fluency
Audience	Teams and professionals who already understand the basics and want practical routines they can reuse.

Learner outcomes

- Build repeatable workflows for common work without copying sensitive data into public tools.
- Use AI to generate first drafts, alternatives, summaries, meeting artifacts, and decision support.
- Develop review habits that keep the human responsible for quality, context, and final judgment.
- Turn scattered experiments into documented workflow recipes that can be shared inside a team.

Guiding questions

- Which tasks repeat often enough to deserve a workflow?
- Where can AI help without becoming the decision maker?
- What inputs are safe to use, and what must be abstracted or withheld?
- How will we review, revise, and document the workflow so others can use it?

Readiness checks

- The workflow has a named owner and a clear final human decision point.
- Inputs avoid sensitive or proprietary data unless a suitable private environment is approved.
- The workflow includes a review step for accuracy, tone, assumptions, and missing context.
- The team can explain when the workflow is useful and when it should not be used.

Research-backed adoption practices

- Prioritize recurring tasks that consume real time or create repeated rework, not flashy demos.

- Break each workflow into inputs, AI assistance, review checkpoints, handoffs, and final ownership.
- Measure usefulness in time saved, quality improved, rework reduced, and review burden created.
- Document the workflow recipe so a useful experiment can become a teachable team practice.

Curriculum modules

Workflow anatomy

We break a task into input, constraints, AI assist, review, revision, and final human decision.

Writing and rewriting

Participants practice using AI for tone, structure, audience adaptation, and first-pass drafting.

Research support without overtrust

We separate brainstorming, query planning, summarization, source checking, and final verification.

Meetings and decisions

Participants create safe workflows for agendas, prep notes, follow-up drafts, and option comparison.

Workflow documentation

Teams capture the steps, prompts, inputs, review points, and human decisions that make a workflow repeatable.

Session flow

Select

Choose one or two common tasks with clear boundaries and enough repetition to justify practice.

Decompose

Break each task into inputs, decisions, drafts, checks, revisions, and final human ownership.

Build

Create prompt sequences and review steps using non-sensitive examples.

Stress test

Try edge cases, poor inputs, missing context, and output-review prompts.

Document

Capture the workflow as a short recipe that names when to use it and when not to.

Practice labs

Writing workflow

Draft, critique, revise, and audience-tune a neutral document while keeping the human responsible for final voice and claims.

Meeting workflow

Generate an agenda, prep questions, follow-up notes, and action-item drafts from fictional or sanitized scenarios.

Research triage workflow

Use AI for question planning and source-triage support, then separate what must be verified elsewhere.

Decision-support workflow

Compare options, surface assumptions, and draft decision criteria without outsourcing the decision itself.

1-2 hour utility projects

These short projects are designed to help individuals experience practical AI utility while keeping inputs safe and human review visible.

How to choose a strong first project

- Real work, low risk: choose a task people already recognize, but keep inputs public, fictional, or sanitized.
- Clear walk-away artifact: produce a brief, agenda, checklist, glossary, comparison table, or reusable prompt sequence.
- Visible judgment step: check claims, name uncertainty, revise tone, or decide what should remain human-led.
- Transferable habit: practice a pattern the learner can reuse later, such as giving context, comparing outputs, or verifying before relying.

Learning Sprint (60-75 minutes)

Turn a confusing topic into a private tutor session.

Walk-away artifact: A one-page explainer, a short quiz, a glossary, and a list of what to verify elsewhere.

Safe input: Use a public topic, a public article, or a concept you want to understand. Avoid private client, patient, employee, or proprietary material.

- Ask for a plain-language explanation at your current level.
- Request examples, analogies, common misconceptions, and a five-question quiz.
- Ask what claims need source checking before you rely on them.

Starter prompt: Teach me [topic] as a smart beginner. Start with a plain-language explanation, then give examples, common misconceptions, a short glossary, a five-question quiz, and a list of claims I should verify with reliable sources.

Decision Clarity Brief (75-90 minutes)

Use AI to make a decision easier to think about without outsourcing the decision.

Walk-away artifact: A comparison table, assumptions list, pre-mortem, missing-information checklist, and final decision questions.

Safe input: Use a personal, public, fictional, or sanitized decision. Keep confidential finances, contracts, medical, legal, or customer details out of public tools.

- Describe the options, constraints, values, and what would count as success.
- Ask AI to compare options and surface assumptions instead of choosing for you.
- Run a pre-mortem and identify what a human should check before acting.

Starter prompt: Help me think through this decision without deciding for me: [safe decision context]. Create criteria, compare options, name assumptions, run a pre-mortem, list missing information, and end with questions I should answer myself.

Meeting Prep Kit (60-90 minutes)

Turn a rough meeting idea into a more useful conversation.

Walk-away artifact: A meeting agenda, prep questions, likely tensions, decision points, and a follow-up email template.

Safe input: Use fictional or sanitized meeting context. Do not paste private attendee notes, personnel details, patient data, customer records, or proprietary plans into public tools.

- Give AI the purpose, audience, desired outcome, and any safe background.
- Ask for an agenda, questions, risks, and decisions to clarify.
- Revise the agenda for tone, time, and who needs to review it.

Starter prompt: Using this fictional or sanitized meeting context, create a focused agenda, prep questions, likely tensions, decision points, and a follow-up email template. Mark anything that needs human confirmation: [context].

Writing Upgrade Studio (60 minutes)

See how AI can draft, critique, and revise with you in a loop.

Walk-away artifact: A stronger email, memo, bio, announcement, or short article with a revision history and review checklist.

Safe input: Use a rough draft that contains no sensitive personal, client, patient, employee, legal, financial, or proprietary details.

- Ask for a first rewrite for a specific audience and tone.
- Ask AI to critique its own draft for clarity, claims, tone, and missing context.
- Request a final revision and make the last edits yourself.

Starter prompt: Improve this rough draft for [audience] with a [tone] tone. Then critique your revision for clarity, unsupported claims, missing context, and anything a human should verify before sending: [safe draft].

Research Compass (90-120 minutes)

Use AI to plan research before you read, search, or cite.

Walk-away artifact: A research question map, search terms, source categories, red flags, and verification plan.

Safe input: Use a public topic or general business question. Do not ask AI to invent citations or make final claims without sources.

- Ask AI to turn a broad topic into better questions and search terms.
- Request source categories, possible biases, and missing perspectives.
- Use the output as a reading plan, then verify claims in actual sources.

Starter prompt: Help me plan research on [public topic]. Create key questions, search terms, source types to seek, likely blind spots, red flags, and a verification checklist. Do not make final claims without sources.

Workflow Recipe Builder (90-120 minutes)

Turn one repeated task into a reusable AI-assisted workflow.

Walk-away artifact: A workflow recipe with inputs, prompt sequence, review gates, human owner, and when-not-to-use guidance.

Safe input: Choose a recurring task and describe it generally or with fictional examples. Keep sensitive operational data out of public tools.

- Map the task into steps, inputs, outputs, review points, and handoffs.
- Ask AI where it can help and where human judgment should stay in charge.
- Create a repeatable prompt sequence and a review checklist.

Starter prompt: Turn this recurring task into a safe AI-assisted workflow recipe: [task]. Include purpose, safe inputs, prompt sequence, review checkpoints, human decision points, risks, and when not to use AI for this task.

Professional Profile Refresh (75-90 minutes)

Use AI as a coach for describing your work more clearly.

Walk-away artifact: A refreshed bio, resume bullet options, interview talking points, and confidence-building practice questions.

Safe input: Use a sanitized career summary or fictionalized role description. Do not include private employer data, references, compensation, or confidential projects.

- Give AI a safe summary of your work, audience, and desired tone.
- Ask for clearer positioning, bullet options, and examples of evidence to add.

- Roleplay interview questions and revise anything that feels inflated or inaccurate.

Starter prompt: Using this sanitized professional summary, help me describe my work more clearly. Draft a short bio, five resume bullet options, three interview talking points, and questions I should answer to make the claims more accurate: [summary].

Personal Planning Co-Pilot (60-75 minutes)

Use AI to turn vague goals into a realistic plan you can actually follow.

Walk-away artifact: A one-week plan, prioritized task list, obstacle plan, review ritual, and next-action checklist.

Safe input: Use personal goals and constraints that are not private, medical, financial, legal, or deeply sensitive.

- Describe the goal, constraints, time available, and what has made it hard.
- Ask AI for a practical plan with tradeoffs and small next actions.
- Review the plan yourself and remove anything unrealistic or intrusive.

Starter prompt: Help me turn this goal into a realistic one-week plan: [safe goal]. Ask clarifying questions if needed, then create priorities, daily actions, likely obstacles, a review ritual, and a simple checklist.

Tangible cases

Meeting-to-action workflow

Situation: A team loses momentum after meetings because notes, decisions, and follow-up messages are inconsistent.

Learner task: Use fictional meeting notes to create an agenda, decision summary, action list, and follow-up draft.

Starter prompt: Using these fictional meeting notes, create a concise decision summary, action-item table, and follow-up email draft. Mark anything that requires human confirmation before sending: [fictional notes].

Policy explainer rewrite

Situation: A department has a dense internal policy that staff struggle to understand.

Learner task: Rewrite a public or sanitized policy excerpt into clearer language, then review for missing nuance.

Starter prompt: Rewrite this public or sanitized policy excerpt for busy staff. Keep the meaning intact, define jargon, list what changed, and identify any part that should be reviewed by the policy owner: [excerpt].

Research question map

Situation: A professional needs to explore an unfamiliar topic before deciding what sources to read.

Learner task: Use AI to generate research questions, search terms, source categories, and verification steps.

Starter prompt: Help me plan research on [topic]. Give me key questions, useful search terms, source types to look for, likely blind spots, and a verification checklist. Do not make final claims without sources.

Prompt library

Workflow recipe

Turn this recurring task into an AI-assisted workflow recipe. Include purpose, safe inputs, prompt sequence, review checkpoints, human decision points, and when not to use the workflow: [task].

Draft and critique

Create a first draft for [audience] using the safe context below. Then critique your own draft for clarity, tone, unsupported claims, missing context, and review needs: [safe context].

Meeting preparation

Using this fictional meeting context, create an agenda, prep questions, risks to discuss, and a follow-up template. Keep all assumptions visible: [fictional context].

Decision support

Compare these options without choosing for me. Create criteria, pros and cons, assumptions, missing information, and questions a human decision maker should answer: [options].

Materials to develop

- Workflow recipe cards
- Meeting preparation worksheet
- Research triage checklist
- Before-and-after prompt examples
- Workflow documentation template
- Human review checkpoint guide

Diagram candidates

These are intentionally left as candidate visuals until diagram parameters are chosen.

- Human-in-the-loop workflow map
- Meeting-to-action pipeline
- Workflow recipe anatomy: inputs, AI assist, review, apply

Follow-up work

- Pilot one documented workflow for two weeks using safe inputs.
- Track where the workflow saves time, improves quality, or creates review burden.
- Bring one workflow back for refinement before scaling it to a broader team.

Session design reminders

- Keep examples non-sensitive and realistic.
- Emphasize education, judgment, review, and careful experimentation.
- Do not promise legal, medical, compliance, cybersecurity, or automation outcomes.
- Name when a stronger tool, private environment, or policy decision is needed before proceeding.

API and tool boundary

This curriculum companion does not require an API call. Any secure password protection, private client portal, or live AI workflow exercise that transmits data to an external model should be reviewed before implementation.